

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting March 20th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ThnZW7sZAzs
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Muncie Redevelopment Commission: Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: March 20, 2025

Audience: Community Members, Local Journalists, Policy Researchers

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee work session held immediately prior to the regular meeting. This section is omitted per guidelines.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called to order the regular meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC) on March 20, 2025 [00:00:34](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pabila, Miss Wagley, and Mr. Lowe (seated in the audience).
 - **Members Absent:** Not specified.

- **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks, though leading procedural votes.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Discussion:** Prior meeting memoranda/minutes were presented. Mr. Dale noted that consequential items were missing from the minutes and stated he would not vote in favor **00:01:46**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by a roll call vote of 4-1 (Mr. Dale voted "no").

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:50 Agenda Amendment: Addition of Downtown Development**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. How
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. How requested to add Downtown Development to the agenda (placed as the first item of other business before grants).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Unanimously by roll call vote.

- **00:02:12 Approval of Claims**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright / Mr. How
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion focused on claims, including a \$350 ReMax charge for valuation on Washington Street lots and a Barnes & Thornburg legal fee invoice (No. 34991) regarding Indiana Stamping/IDEM oversight. Mr. Dale raised concerns that Indiana Stamping is a project of the Muncie Community Development Corporation, not the MRC, and questioned why MRC is paying its legal fees. Staff noted they would investigate reallocating the charge. Mr. Dale moved to approve the claims minus the disputed legal payment, noting the claim would be paid otherwise from another source.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Dale and Miss Wagley voted "no"; Mr. Bishop, Mr. Miller, and Mr. Pabila voted "yes").

- **00:12:05 Downtown Development: Replacement Planters**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Vicky (Muncie Downtown Development Partnership)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Vicky presented a request for replacement limestone-style planters downtown, which are roughly 10 years old, damaged by traffic, and difficult to maintain. The proposed replacements are made of heavier resin with built-in water

reserves and rounded shapes to reduce impact damage. Community Enhancement Projects (CEP) agreed to continue planting them four times a year.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and **Approved by Voice Vote** (recorded as a unanimous roll call vote subsequent to motion: Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pabila, and Miss Wagley voting “yes”) for an amount not to exceed \$37,773.08 from Central Tiff funds.

- 00:19:57 **Property Grant / Transfer to Muncie Land Bank**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. How
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for approval to grant/transfer three MRC-held properties (719, 819, and 927 West Powers) to the Muncie Land Bank. These properties have been held by MRC since 2017, 2016, and 2018 respectively. The transfer supports a Ready Grant application partnership (City of Muncie, Muncie Land Bank, Intend Indiana, and WS Properties) and provides full retail value as the required grant match.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Unanimously by roll call vote.

- 00:22:57 **Property Purchase Application: Women Support Girls / Women Support Each Other**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How / Representative of “Women Support Girls”
- **Deliberation Summary:** An application by a non-profit organization to purchase a vacant residential/variety business zoned lot for \$250 to install a custom shed/barn structure to serve as a headquarters for mentoring young women and holding support groups. Board members and legal counsel discussed front setback requirements (25 ft from right-of-way) under variety business zoning, utility verifications, and property lot dimensions (~27 ft wide). Staff noted standard contingencies apply.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** The applicant spoke on the organization’s mission, previous events held at the YWCA and Walker Center, and the need for a permanent headquarters [00:24:16](#).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Unanimously by roll call vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No citizens signed up or spoke during the general open public comment period [00:43:34](#).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- **Mr. How (City Updates):** Provided financial reports (Total Tiff balances at \$732,517; planned investments and focused funds totaling nearly \$2 million; estimated consolidated Tiff funds at year-end projected near \$3.76 million). Noted ongoing discussions regarding a downtown hotel project, progress at Storer Estates (DR Horton acquiring 9 additional lots; playground heavily utilized), Village Development collaborations, wireless communication tower site rejections/relocations, and a public art initiative with the Muncie Arts and Culture Council.
- **Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank):** Provided updates on neighborhood engagement (Industry, South Central, Old West End, Whitely), a potential transfer of 11 shovel-ready properties to Intend Indiana, partnerships with for-profit developers, visiting planners from South Bend and Fort Wayne, and a \$20,000 operational grant from the Community Foundation.
- **Commissioner Comments:** Mr. Dale noted excitement regarding home sales and development progress at Storer Estates and wished Mr. How a happy birthday.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment disposition: Approved. Next meeting scheduled for April 17, 2025 [00:44:13](#).

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